

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Saul D. Bid

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Saul D. Bid

Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House

Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiquities, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider.

- Longtime professional rival of **Hugh Bidder**.

ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Saul D. Bid. Going once, going twice—no, I am only asking someone to pass the bread.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Saul D. Bid

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Your other secret

You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Conversations to start

- Compare notes with Hugh Bidder about Grant's demands on auction houses.
- Ask Elon Mosaic what he expects from tonight's unveiling. Keep your private sale to yourself for now.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A screen steals every eye. The evidence has slipped out of view behind it.*
- 2 *The award has already been won. Its underside offers another reward.*
- 3 *The clue is keeping company with the lamp in green.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant wanted me to waive a fee or explain a discreet subsidiary sale to my partners. I arranged it outside the auction house's ordinary process. The client requested anonymity; I supplied a little too much of it. Grant had never objected to discretion while he was buying. His standards improved remarkably when my invoice arrived.

IF MURDERER

I routed a private sale through a subsidiary. Grant knew and wanted a fee waived in return for silence. He proposed calling my partners during the gala if I declined. One grows accustomed to theatrical bids. A threat to dismantle the auction house that bears one's name is a less amusing variation.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I used the valuation booth before the toast to argue with the insurer about the sale. The display clock on the recording said 6:49. I gave them six minutes of my very best courtesy. Afterward I walked back through the gallery. Grant's fee demand was in my breast pocket, ready for an answer.

IF MURDERER

I took the insurer's callback on my own telephone while walking the gallery. The booth recording was already being prepared for export. I inspected the bowl early and returned to the outer table before the toast. Grant's fee demand remained in my breast pocket. I intended to give him a counteroffer he would dislike.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

You will hear me say 'going twice' on the fixed booth recording while the insurer refuses my valuation. The overlay runs 6:49 to 6:55; it uses the brass clock. The subsidiary ledger remained in my case. Grant wanted the fee gone and the sale discreet. He was particularly insistent on receiving both services together.

IF MURDERER

I kept the subsidiary ledger in my case and used my own phone for the insurer's counteroffer. 'Going twice' is an expression I use often. Grant's papers may contain another example. He wanted a free transaction and an appreciative smile. I had prepared a fee statement that would have made both rather difficult.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Saul D. Bid

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Tear off this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Saul D. Bid

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The subsidiary sale bypassed our normal process. The insurer's fixed-line recording accounts for me once its brass-clock overlay is corrected. My ledger was real, as was the fee dispute. I would have preferred a settlement and the full commission. I did not poison Grant, and I will not waive the outstanding invoice.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not take the recorded fixed-line call; I used my mobile as cover. The reference sample traveled inside the cloth around the subsidiary ledger. I wiped Grant's empty coupe while delivering the disputed invoice. He expected a waived fee. I supplied an ending he had not priced into his threat.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.